

DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy

Submitted by: Swattik Pradhan

Registration No: 25BCE10457

Branch: B. Tech CSE (Core)

Submission Date: March 31, 2026

Task1: Create a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

To create the infographic for this project, I used **Canva**, which provided the flexibility needed to balance educational content with a visually engaging layout. The design is structured into three distinct pillars—Digital Literacy, Safe Internet Practices, and Professional Online Presence—to offer a comprehensive guide for students navigating the modern web.

The central section focuses heavily on security, using clear icons like shields and padlocks to emphasize the importance of strong passwords and privacy settings. The "Professional Online Presence" section specifically targets the student demographic by highlighting LinkedIn and the value of showcasing academic achievements. I aimed for a clean, professional colour palette of blues and teals to evoke a sense of trust and authority, which is essential when discussing topics like cybersecurity.

One thing I found particularly **interesting** while designing this was the challenge of "visual hierarchy"—the art of making sure the most important information catches the eye first without overwhelming the viewer. It was fascinating to see how simple icon placement and bold

headers could transform a dense list of safety tips into an easily digestible guide. Balancing the text with illustrations required constant refinement to ensure the message remained clear at a single glance.

Task2: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For my professional development over the next four years, I have selected **Stack Overflow**, **GitHub**, and **Kaggle** as my primary digital platforms. Each serves a distinct purpose in building a robust technical foundation and a visible professional brand.

GitHub will serve as my primary version control and project repository. It is where I will host my source code, document my technical journey, and collaborate on open-source projects. Over the next four years, I plan to use it to build a diverse portfolio that demonstrates my coding consistency and ability to work within a team.

Stack Overflow is my go-to resource for troubleshooting and community-driven learning. While I currently use it to find solutions to complex bugs, my long-term goal is to transition from a consumer to a contributor—answering questions to solidify my own understanding and build a reputation within the global developer community.

Finally, I chose **Kaggle** to hone my data science and machine learning skills. Beyond just downloading datasets, I plan to participate in monthly competitions and study "Kernels" shared by experts. By the end of my degree, I aim to have a collection of high-ranking notebooks that prove my analytical capabilities to potential employers.

Task3: Explore Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For this section of the project, I utilized **CodeChef** for technical skill-building and **Google Workspace** (specifically Google Forms and Sheets) for collaborative data management. On CodeChef, I focused on Python fundamentals, as seen in my script `cse.py`. I practiced basic data manipulation by writing a program that calculates the sum, average, and

maximum value from a list of integers. This exercise helped me understand built-in functions like `sum()`, `len()`, and `max()`, which are essential building blocks for more complex algorithmic thinking.

Simultaneously, I developed a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms to engage with my batchmates. Creating the five questions—ranging from multiple-choice to short-answer formats—allowed me to practice structured data collection. Linking the form to a Google Sheet was particularly insightful, as it demonstrated how real-time responses can be organized and analysed instantly.

Academically, these tools are invaluable. Mastering platforms like CodeChef prepares me for competitive programming and technical interviews, ensuring I stay sharp in my core subjects. Meanwhile, proficiency in Google Workspace streamlines my ability to conduct research, collaborate on group assignments, and manage project data efficiently. These combined skills bridge the gap between theoretical coding and practical, data-driven communication.

Task4: Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

In my experience building the **Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz** and practicing on **CodeChef**, I've realized that clear communication is the backbone of technical success. A real-world example of where this failed is the **2018 Hawaii false missile alert**. Due to a poorly designed interface and ambiguous button labels, a state official accidentally broadcast a terrifying emergency message to the entire population. The lack of a "confirm action" step and the use of confusing jargon led to 38 minutes of statewide panic.

To prevent such issues in my own career, I plan to use **GitHub** and **Stack Overflow** to practice "Clean Coding" and precise documentation. By writing clear comments in my scripts—like the ones in my `cse.py` file—and providing detailed descriptions for my Google Form questions, I am learning to ensure my digital intent is never misunderstood. Over the next four years, these habits will help me collaborate effectively on group projects and build a professional presence that is both technically sound and easy for others to navigate.

Task5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Researching UPI and online payment fraud was eye-opening, but what surprised me most was the sheer **scale and speed** of these crimes. According to recent 2026 data, UPI fraud incidents in India have surged, with over **13.4 lakh cases** reported in a single financial year. It was shocking to learn that scammers aren't just using basic technical hacks; they are master psychologists who use "hyper-contextual" social engineering—sometimes even mirroring a victim's recent Google searches or marketplace listings to build instant, false trust.

As a result of this research, the one habit I will personally change is my **level of "digital scepticism" during incoming requests**. Previously, I might have trusted a "Collect Request" if the person sounded professional. Now, I have committed to a **"Zero-Trust" policy** for all financial notifications: I will never enter my PIN or scan a QR code unless I am the one initiating a payment. I've also started double-checking the **verified merchant name** on every transaction, a simple step that can prevent most modern UPI scams.